

A

Verb and noun collocations

collocation	example
go along with an idea / a view	I go along with your view that crime and poverty are linked.
be in (complete) agreement	We are in complete agreement over the question of drug abuse in athletics.
tend to agree/disagree	I tend to agree that parents often blame teachers for problems which start within the family.
share an opinion / a view	I share your opinion that sport is over-commercialised.
appreciate someone's point of view	I appreciate your point of view , but I still think you are overstating the problem.
see someone's point [understand their opinion]	I can see your point ; I've never thought of it in that way before.
enter into an argument	I'd prefer not to enter into an argument over the result of the elections.
differences arise/exist	Differences exist / have arisen between the unions and the management over how to solve the problem.
come to / reach a compromise	We disagree over what to do, but I'm sure we can come to / reach a compromise .
settle a dispute / your differences	The management and the union have finally settled their pay dispute . I'm sure we can settle our differences without damaging our friendship.
agree to differ [agree to have different opinions]	I don't think we will ever agree with each other. We'll just have to agree to differ .

B

Verb and adverb collocations

verb	adverb	example
agree	entirely/ wholeheartedly	I entirely agree with you on the question of nuclear waste.
agree	partly / up to a point	I agree up to a point , but I also think there are other important factors.
disagree	fundamentally/ totally/strongly	The two philosophers disagreed fundamentally over the effect of the environment on behaviour.

C

Adjective and noun collocations for disputes and strong disagreements

I've often disagreed strongly with Nancy but I've never had such a **head-on clash** with her before.
[disagreement where two people confront each other directly]

The **bitter dispute** between the two groups finally led to violence.

We had a very **heated argument** about immigration the other day.

Jeff and I had a **fundamental disagreement** over who should be the next Chair of the club.

D

Further collocations for agreeing and disagreeing

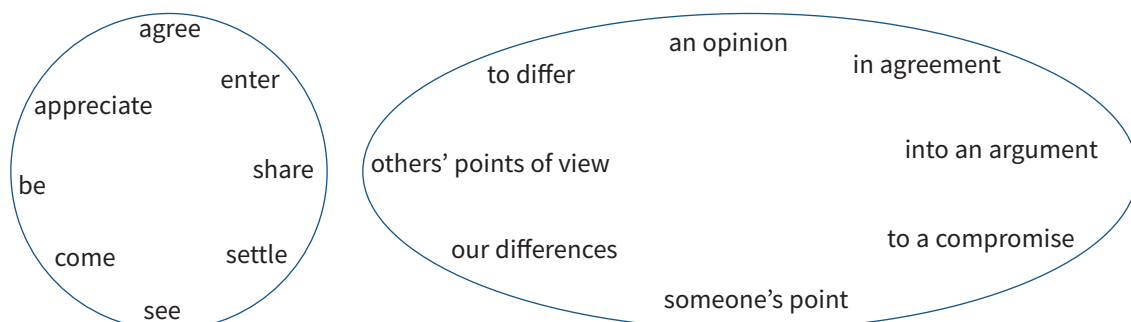
The Regional Education Committee has reached a **unanimous agreement** on a new system of exams for secondary schools.

Controversy continues to **exist/rage** over the appointment of the new Director.

A **conflict of opinion** within the National Olympic Association is threatening to delay the building of a new stadium.

Exercises

- 55.1** Look at A. Make collocations by matching words from the circle on the left with words from the oval on the right.



- 55.2** Put the expressions from the box into the appropriate category below.

a controversy rages	a head-on clash	a heated argument
settle a dispute	come to a compromise	differences exist

reaching agreement	disagreeing

- 55.3** Rewrite each sentence using the word in brackets, so that it keeps the same meaning.

- I don't completely agree with what you say. (POINT)
- I am in total agreement with you. (ENTIRELY)
- There was no disagreement among the committee members. (UNANIMOUS)
- There will always be differences of opinion even between friends. (ARISE)
- James and Ben had a big disagreement over the question of climate change. (STRONGLY)
- The project has been delayed because of the different opinions among the members of the committee. (CONFLICT)
- I find it difficult to agree with such an idea. (ALONG)
- We are in total disagreement about most things. (FUNDAMENTALLY)

- 55.4** Answer these questions about the collocations on the opposite page.

- Which collocation suggests that a disagreement is like a high temperature?
- Which two collocations suggest that a disagreement is like a fight or a war?
- Which collocation suggests that controversy is like anger?
- Why do you think the word *bitter* is used to refer to quarrels and disputes as well as to taste?
- Which collocation suggests that understanding someone's opinion is like using your eyes?

A

Speaking about beliefs and opinions

I **firmly believe** that young people should have the right to vote at 16.



I **share your opinion** on the issue of hunting. I'm **a great believer in** animals' rights.



Contrary to **popular belief**¹, it is not true that blondes are dumb.



We **have reason to believe** that you witnessed the accident.

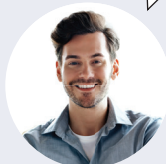


¹ what many people think

We are **poles apart**² in our attitudes to life.



It's **a matter of opinion** whether men are better drivers than women.



I had a **difference of opinion**³ with my brother.



³ disagreement

I've got a **sneaking suspicion**⁴ you may be right.



⁴ I'm beginning to think

² are completely different

B

More formal ways of discussing beliefs

Look at this extract from a student essay and notice the collocations referring to beliefs.

The writer seems to **make assumptions**¹ based on an **unshakeable belief** in the superiority of her own value system. She seems to be unaware of the extent to which her own **set of beliefs** has **coloured her judgement**². Her research **leads her to conclude** that military action was justified. However, her **evidence is based on** one single document and **attaches** too much **importance** to this. I do not **trust her judgement**. Moreover, other documents **cast doubt on**³ her conclusions. **Opinions** on the issue **are divided**⁴ and my own **considered opinion**⁵ is that the writer is not to be trusted. I **have serious misgivings about**⁶ her research and I **have doubts** about the accuracy of some of her facts.

¹ thinks or says things are true without enough evidence

² affected her judgement

³ suggest something may be wrong with

⁴ people have different opinions

⁵ opinion after much thought

⁶ I have serious doubts about

C

Some error warnings

The expressions in this table are collocations that learners often have difficulty with.

collocation	comment
I hope you'll come to my party.	NOT wish
They've given up hope of any survivors.	NOT the hope
We need to think hard about this problem.	NOT consider hard – could be consider this problem carefully
I wish they would just leave me alone .	NOT let
Many people hold the view/opinion that ...	NOT meaning
He has strong opinions on many subjects.	NOT heavy or big

Exercises

56.1 Look at A. Complete the collocations in these letters to a newspaper.

Sir/Madam, I (1) the opinion of your correspondent that the EU has brought peace to Europe, but I cannot agree that a single currency for all of Europe is necessary. It is a (2) of opinion whether economic stability can be maintained with one currency, and there is (3) to believe that some European economies were more stable before they joined the euro. Yours, L. Knight	Sir/Madam, According to popular (4), the war between Gronbia and Karzkut started with a (5) of opinion over how best to preserve the beautiful mountain environment on both sides of the border between them. The two countries were apparently (6) apart on how to approach the issue, and war resulted. If this is indeed true, how stupid can human beings become? Yours sincerely, B. Stephenson	Sir/Madam, While I (7) believe in the right of everyone to own a car, I am also a great (8) in keeping fit and healthy. The government tells us we must take exercise, but I have a (9) suspicion that they are afraid of saying we should sell our cars because they would lose billions in road taxes. Yours, S. Adams
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56.2 Correct the seven collocation errors in this text.

I wish we can solve a big problem we have regarding our student committee. Opinions are separated about how to approach the issue and, naturally, some members have very heavy opinions. Some of their views are based on their unstirred belief that they are always right and that no one can challenge their group of beliefs. My own thoughtful opinion is that we should have new elections, but I know that others have quite a different meaning.

56.3 Match each verb in the box with its noun collocation in the table below. Then write one sentence for each collocation.

cast colour attach make have trust

	verb	noun
1		assumptions
2		somebody's judgement
3		
4		importance to
5		doubt on
6		serious misgivings
		doubts

56.4 Make seven collocations using the words in the box. Use each word once only.

apart belief believe cast think firmly hard opinions
sneaking strong suspicion doubt poles popular